

1983

Lots Of Launches—And A Lame Windows

January: The Spreadsheet Evolves

Released on 26th January 1983, Louts 1-2-3 was a spreadsheet application for the IBM PC and OS/2. It was developed by Jonathan Sachs, who co-founded Lotus Development Corporation. This software was almost a clone of VisiCalc, a popular spreadsheet program of the time. The only difference was that Lotus 1-2-3 was written entirely in assembly language and so was able to perform tasks faster.



The earliest version of Lotus 1-2-3

The “1-2-3” was appended to the software name because it offered three basic functions—spreadsheet, charting/graphing, and basic database operations. It also indicated ease of use. The earliest versions had keyboard-driven menus and one-key commands to make frequently-used commands faster to access. It was also the first spreadsheet application to introduce naming of cells, cell ranges and the concept of automatically doing tasks using macros.